

```
<script src="http://connect.facebook.net/en_US/all.js#appId=YOURAPP
IDHERE&xfbml=1"></script>
<script>
    FB.init({
        appId: 'YOUR APPID HERE', cookie: true,
        status: true, xfbml: true
    });
    FB.Event.subscribe('auth.login', function (response) {
        fblogin();
    });
    function fblogin(){
    FB.api('/me', function(response) {
        alert("You have successfully logged in, "+response.name+"!");
    });
    }
</script>
<fb:login-button> Login to LinuxForYou.com</fb:login-button>
</body>
</html>
```

This JavaScript code and XFBML tag will show a button, which when clicked, will prompt for Facebook credentials, and for the permissions to grant to this website. The JavaScript is programmed to subscribe to this event. As soon as the user logs in, it executes the *fblogin* function, and displays an *alert* box that greets the logged-in user by name. Basically, in this function we have performed a Facebook JavaScript SDK API call (with the *'me'* query), asking for the current user's profile information, which is returned in the response object. From that, we extract the name and display it; other details also can be extracted, for registration purposes. *FB.init* and *FB.event.subscribe* initialise the JavaScript SDK, and subscribe to the login event, respectively. Note that before trying out this code, you will have to get your own app ID and paste it wherever required. For a more sophisticated registration, you can also use other plug-ins provided by Facebook, such as the registration plug-in. These, and all other plug-ins, can be used in a manner similar to what's been described above.

The Graph API

The most basic way of accessing information from Facebook is the Graph API. The Open Graph Protocol and the Facebook Graph API are the two heavyweights in Facebook application development. The Graph API presents a huge social graph of accessible information to the application, in the form of usable data, while the Open Graph Protocol brings Facebook to almost every part of the Web, and extends the usability of the 'Like' button in hitherto unimaginable places. To give you a trailer, try and visit <https://graph.facebook.com/LinuxForYou>. You should see text that looks something like the following:

```
{
  "id": "58679349432",
  "name": "Linux For You",
```

```
  "picture": "http://profile.ak.fbcdn.net/hprofile-ak-
snc4/58679349432_282_s.jpg",
  "link": "http://www.facebook.com/LinuxForYou",
  "category": "News/media",
  "likes": 52154,
  "website": "http://www.linuxforu.com",
  "username": "LinuxForYou",
  "founded": "February, 2003",
  "company_overview": "The first issue of the magazine had hit the
stands in February 2003, since then it has been catering to newbies,
powerusers, administrators, developers and those belonging to the
IT industry. The magazine aims at providing complete solution for
deployment of Linux. ",
  "mission": "To accelerate adoption and creation of Open Source
solutions.",
  "products": "LINUX For You Magazine\nLinuxforu.com Portal\nLFY CDs
& DVDs (accompany magazine)"
}
```

That is the Graph URL of LFY's page, and the information returned is in the form of JSON. This can be parsed in a manner similar to XML, but it is more compact, and represents information in the form of key-value pairs. To get a hang of the Graph API, you can go to <https://www.simoncross.com/fb/graph/> and browse the API which is in the form of a comfortable GUI Web application.

For the most part, in order to access advanced information, we need to get an access token with the help of OAuth 2.0 authorisation, which then gives an access token for a specified period of time. This token is then passed over an HTTPS connection as a parameter to the Graph API, to access information for which the user has granted access. The ID field returned in the above example is used to access any object in the social graph, such as a page, person, event, group, application, photo, video, etc, and is unique for any such object. We can browse the social graph, with the help of connections between these objects. There are several connection types possible, such as, friends, likes, movies, music, photos, etc. An example of such a query would be:

```
https://graph.facebook.com/me/friends?access\_token=ACCESSTOKENHERE
```

There are different methods to get the access token on the client side and on the server side; explaining each of these methods in detail here would be a waste of space and time, so we will just point you to a reference [2].

You can also post on behalf of the user, if you have permission to do so, using the HTTP POST method. For example:

```
curl -F 'access_token=ACCESSTOKENHERE' \
-F 'message:I love Facebook!' \
https://graph.facebook.com/USERID/feed
```

The API is very detailed, and offers many other features besides those demonstrated here.